

Cotality-Westpac NZ First Home Buyer Report, May 2026

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Share

Housing market conditions have remained favourable for first home buyers in the early part of 2026.



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- FHBs' market share remains high. In Q1 2026, they accounted for 27.5% of property purchases across NZ, just short of the record high of 28.2% set in the final three months of last year. In a busier

overall market, they are buying more properties too.

- Over the past 12 months, FHBs have purchased around 24,800 properties, the highest annual total since Q3 2021 (25,650).
- This strength for FHBs is being seen right across the country, with market shares running above their own long-term averages since 2005. For example, across the wider Wellington area, FHBs accounted for 37% of activity in Q1 2026, about 8%-points above its average. Hamilton has also been strong, alongside Napier, Gisborne, and 'provincial' areas such as the South Waikato and Waikato Districts.
- This high level of activity hasn't meant too many compromises either. Standalone houses have comprised nearly 77% of all FHB purchases so far in 2026, up from 75% last year, and the highest figure since 2020 (which was 78%).

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